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‘Cheap stunt’ or smart strategy? Candidate’s Flock camera signs draw attention

Political experts say the move could boost recognition in Yavapai College Board race

Yavapai College candidate Ryan Jones is blanketing Prescott with signs warning about license plate reader cameras in his run for the District 4 seat.

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PRESCOTT, AZ (AZFamily) — Less than two weeks out from the midterm election and its the final stretch for candidates to sell themselves to voters.

In smaller, local races, name recognition is a big part of the game.

Last week, we reported on a candidate for Yavapai College Board that was placing campaign signs under Flock cameras around Prescott.

“It is absolutely a cheap stunt to get attention to my campaign. But, you know, I’m putting up these signs. They don’t have my name written across it in big letters. So, it’s also calling attention to a bigger issue,” said Ryan Jones, during an interview with Arizona’s Family last week.

Jones placed signs that read “Flock Cam Here” and “Private AI Cams Tracking YOU” with a small disclaimer about his campaign and some of that information at the bottom.

It’s not overtly a campaign sign, but it could play a role in the race.

“Three quarters of the battle in almost any election is just having people know who you are,” explained Republican Political Consultant Barrett Marson.

These signs are not the first example of candidates using stunts to bring more attention to their campaigns, but this election cycle tapping into ALPR cameras and the bipartisan concerns can leave a positive mark on a candidate. Reaction on social media to the story suggests it might be working.

“Talk about Flock and AI and data centers, that grabs voters’ attention. Remember, especially on signs, you’re driving by at 40 miles an hour, 35 miles an hour. It’s quick. It’s like that,” said Marson.

In a race as small as Yavapai College Board, there's no public polling available before the election. So it's hard to know the true impact of these signs on this race. But political consultants agree it's a strategy that can work.

"That's why people do signs to begin with, to make sure that people recognize their name when they go to the ballot and go, oh, that's that person. This added recall allows that to associate it with probably a fairly favorable issue in this cycle, because of all the public concern about the security around the data. So you're going to remember that guy associatively in the midst of this storm of information that's going on," explained President and CEO of Highground Inc. Chuck Coughlin.

The Yavapai College District Governing Board is made up of five members from different districts. The role of the board is to 'act as a link between the taxpayers and management, directing and regulating the organization on the taxpayers' behalf'.

Jones is running against Kara Woods and Linda Gray for the District 4 seat in the nonpartisan race.

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